

2027 Alternative Space LOOP

Open Call for Exhibition Proposal — Application Form

Applicant: Darius Nazarov (OGOxWOW Buro), Belgrade, Serbia

Exhibition title: Mold.log — Controlled Experiment

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1. Biography

Darius Nazarov is an artist based in Belgrade, Serbia, trained in parametric architecture. His practice spans experimental Art & Science games and media installations, using digital systems to explore natural processes and the emotions they provoke. He represents OGOxWOW Buro, an art collective bringing together several artists, and presents Mold.log as an individual author.

My interest is in the natural processes we prefer not to look at — decay, growth, contamination — and in the emotions they trigger. I build small, controllable digital systems that let a viewer stay with that discomfort long enough for it to become curiosity. I studied different types of mold in courses and meet it constantly in everyday life; digitising and gamifying it is my personal way of making peace with it. My future goal is to develop this method into a series of 'controlled experiments' on other unwelcome natural processes (rust, rot, dust), and to test them with audiences outside my own context — which is why an exhibition in Seoul is important to me.

2. Exhibition Overview

Exhibition title	Mold.log — Controlled Experiment
Participating artist	Darius Nazarov (solo exhibition)
Preferred period	Flexible; any 3–5 week slot in 2027. Preference for spring (Mar–May) or autumn (Sep–Nov) 2027.
Theme / keywords	mold, contamination, control, observation, discomfort → curiosity, generative systems, playable art, monochrome, laboratory record, sound

3. Exhibition Background and Concept

Mold is the invisible world that quietly eats the spaces we live in. Most of us react to it with disgust and try not to look. **Mold.log** asks what happens when the same process is made observable, reversible and — above all — playable.

The work is a browser-based generative system. In a virtual Petri dish, visitors place spores, choose a strain (the strains are named after real fungi and bacteria: *Neurospora crassa*, *Aspergillus flavus*, *Penicillium chrysogenum*, *Bacillus subtilis*, *Proteus mirabilis* and others), and watch colonies branch, layer and collide as they compete for nutrients. Each colony adds its own voice to a slowly building polyphonic soundscape. The image is monochrome and pixelated, like a laboratory record; the visitor can pause the process, burn the dish clean, and start again. Every session can also be exported as a PNG — a unique 'record' of one experiment.

The exhibition frames the gallery as a small laboratory in which the visitor takes the role of an observer running a controlled experiment. Three questions organise it: **(1)** How does control over representation change emotion — does fear become curiosity when a process can be paused and undone? **(2)** What kind of 'nature' is a simulation that borrows real names and real growth logics but contains no living matter? **(3)** What accumulates when many visitors run the same experiment — can a gallery grow an archive of a process that usually happens beyond attention?

The contemporary context is double: on one side, post-pandemic anxiety about invisible biological agents and the 'hygienic' visual culture that hides them; on the other, a generation that learned to relate to the world through systems that can be saved, reset and replayed. Mold.log sits exactly between the two.

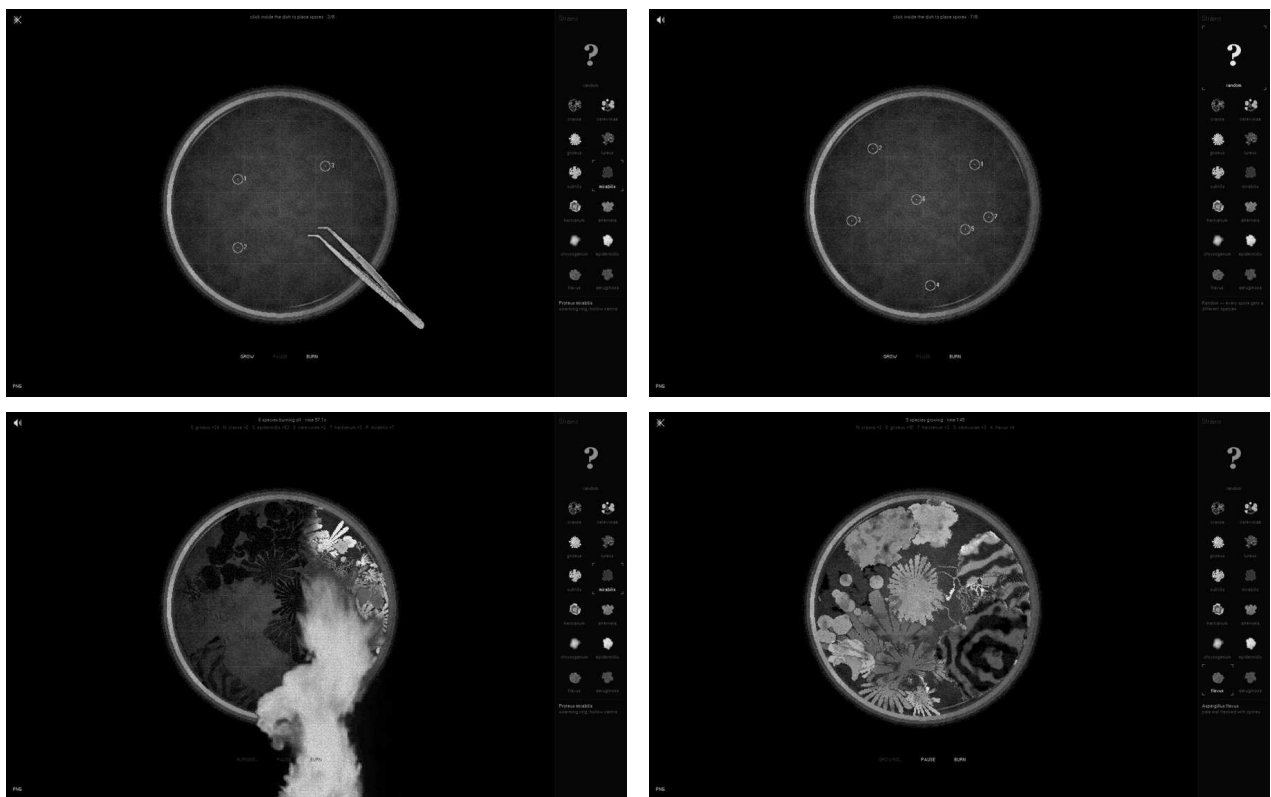
Why LOOP: the work is small, quiet and needs time; it suits a space where visitors can sit with one thing rather than pass through. LOOP's history of experimental formats and its interest in the social role of art match the participatory second half of the project (see sections 5 and 7).

4. Participating Artist and Key Works

Artist name	Darius Nazarov (OGOxWOW Buro), b. 2002, based in Belgrade, Serbia
Biography	Darius Nazarov is an artist based in Belgrade, Serbia, trained in parametric architecture. His practice spans experimental Art & Science games and media installations, using digital systems to explore natural processes and the emotions they provoke. He represents OGOxWOW Buro, an art collective bringing together several artists, and presents Mold.log as an individual author.
Key work	Mold.log (2026) — browser-based generative art game / interactive digital installation. HTML5, procedural growth simulation, generative sound. Duration: a single growth cycle $\approx$ 1 minute; sessions are open-ended.
Links	Playable version: https://darixyz.github.io/petri-mold/ Images and gameplay teaser: https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1zaVo7N3MKv_c3ov3awPn4lomXxDs-FVz Source: https://github.com/DariyXYZ/petri-mold

Work description

Visitors interact with a mouse only. A side panel offers a set of strains and a 'random' option; clicking inside the dish places a spore. Growth runs in real time; colonies inhibit each other where they meet, producing seams and layered textures. PAUSE freezes the record; BURN clears the dish with a fire animation and keeps the same dish for the next experiment; PNG exports the current state at print resolution. Sound can be switched on or off and is designed for low volume. The work is a deliberately artistic interpretation, not a biological model.



Screenshots: strain selection and early growth; a full dish with five species; BURN clearing the dish.

5. Spatial Plan

The exhibition uses LOOP's main room as one darkened laboratory. Walls stay black or dark grey; the only light comes from the screens, the projection and a low print-wall light. Elements (see diagram, letters refer to the LOOP floor plan):

A, B — two experiment stations. Small tables or plinths near the window wall, each with a monitor, a mouse and a chair. No keyboard. Visitors run their own dishes here. Stations are placed so that two people can play without seeing each other's screen directly, but hear each other's sound.

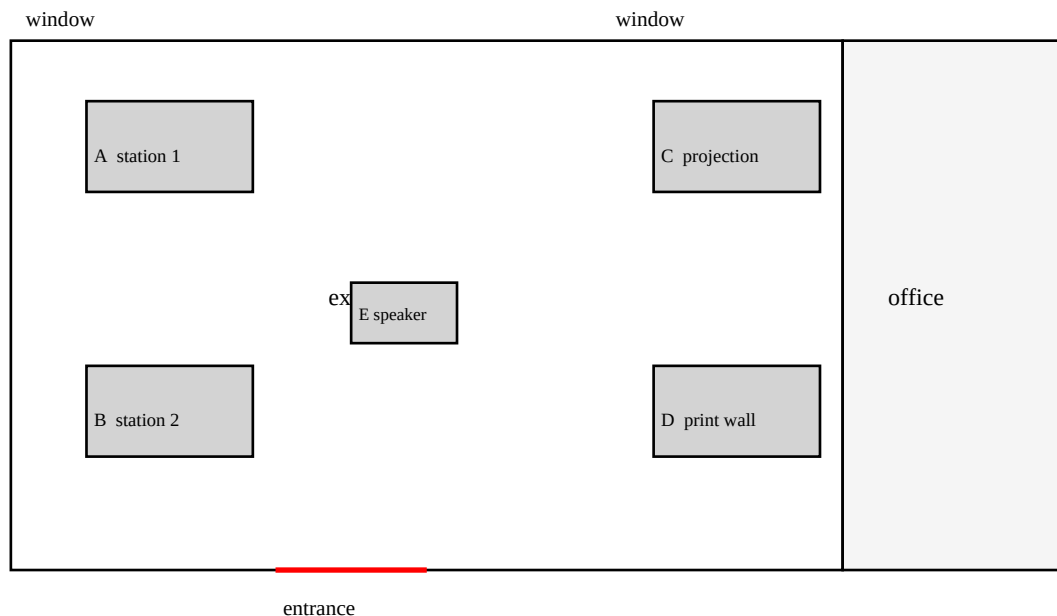
C — projection. The far wall shows a large mirror of station A (or an unattended long-run dish), so visitors entering see growth before they understand it is being controlled by someone in the room.

D — print wall. A growing archive: PNG exports chosen by visitors are printed (A5, monochrome, on plain paper) and pinned in a grid. The wall starts empty on opening day and fills during the exhibition.

E — sound. One small speaker per station at low volume; the projection is silent. The room's sound is the sum of the two live dishes.

Visitor flow: entrance → projection (C) visible first → stations (A, B) → print wall (D) on the way out.

Nothing is fixed to the walls except the print grid; installation needs one day and de-installation half a day.



Technical: two computers with a browser (LOOP equipment where available; otherwise two mini-PCs), two monitors, two mice, one projector, two small speakers, one A5 printer for the print wall. The work runs offline once cached. Installation can be completed remotely with LOOP staff if the artist cannot travel; the artist's presence for the opening week is planned (see budget).

6. Budget Plan

Item	Details	Budget (KRW)	Notes
Artwork production	Adaptation of the work for gallery mode (kiosk build, Korean UI labels, long-run projection mode); artist fee	300,000	LOOP support
Equipment / technical	Rental of 2 mini-PCs / monitors if not covered by LOOP equipment; cables, mounts; A5 printer and paper for the print wall	400,000	LOOP support; LOOP projector and speakers requested
Shipping / install / de-install	No shipping (digital work); local install materials; assistant for one day	150,000	LOOP support
Other	Artist talk / workshop materials; documentation photos	150,000	LOOP support
Total (LOOP support)		1,000,000	
Artist travel & stay	Belgrade–Seoul flight and 7–10 days accommodation for opening week	≈ 2,000,000	Self-funded / external

Funding plan beyond LOOP support. The work itself is finished and needs no production budget beyond adaptation, so LOOP's grant covers the whole installation. Travel is self-funded, with applications planned to mobility funds (e.g. Serbian Ministry of Culture mobility support, Asia–Europe Foundation / Culture360 mobility grants). If travel funding fails, the exhibition is fully realisable with remote installation and an online artist talk — the work was designed for that from the start.

7. Publicity and Audience Engagement Plan

Opening experiment. On opening night the dishes are empty and the print wall is blank; the first visitors seed the first colonies. The state of the room at closing is documented as the exhibition's final 'record'.

Workshop 'Grow your strain' (1 session, 90 min, 8–12 participants). Participants design a strain — growth rule, texture, sound — and the artist implements a small number of them live; the new strains join the game for the rest of the run. Suited to teenagers and adults; no coding needed.

Artist talk (in person or online). 'Making peace with mold': on discomfort, control and simulation, with a live session on the projection.

Print wall as publication. At the end, the visitor-selected prints are scanned and released as a free PDF zine (and, if LOOP wishes, a small risograph edition).

Online. The work stays playable online during and after the show; a LOOP-specific link records which dishes were grown in Seoul. Social media: process posts from @ogowow_buro and LOOP's channels; a short gameplay teaser exists.

8. Selected Exhibitions and Projects (past five years)

Project	Period	Venue	Artists / Role	Description
ExtraLives	2026	Boston Cyberarts Gallery, Boston (US)	Darius Nazarov / artist	Group show of experimental games and playable art; Mold.log presented as a playable station.
Video Game Artshow	2025–2026	Another Corner	Darius Nazarov / artist	Group exhibition of video-game art.
Signal	2024	Signal festival (RU)	Darius Nazarov, OGOxWOW Buro / artist	Media installation in the festival art programme.
Archstoyanie	2024	Nikola-Lenivets (RU)	Darius Nazarov, OGOxWOW Buro / artist	Site-specific media installation at the land-art festival.
Architecton	2024	with SA Lab	Darius Nazarov / artist	Media installation produced with SA Lab.

9. Reference Materials / Portfolio

Playable version: <https://dariyxyz.github.io/petri-mold/>

Images and gameplay teaser:

https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1zaVo7N3MKv_c3ov3awPn4IomXxDs-FVz

Source: <https://github.com/DariyXYZ/petri-mold>

Artist statement

I studied different types of mold in courses and encounter it frequently in everyday life. I am unsettled by the invisible world that quietly consumes what surrounds us. Digitisation and gamification are personal ways of working through that feeling: by breaking a natural process down and observing it closely, I can begin to make peace with it. Mold.log gives this method a playable form. The Petri dish becomes a contained space in which fear can turn into curiosity. The image is mediated, monochrome, and available for inspection; the process can be paused, cleared, and approached again. This sense of control allows me — and, I hope, the visitor — to spend time with something we might otherwise prefer not to see.



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Thank you!